

them in the bottom quartile for all people with similar income and age characteristics? Some are incredulous. Many want to change

but are uncertain how to transform themselves. How can someone change when they have more than twenty years' experience as a UAW?

First, they must really want to change. Second, they will likely need some professional help. Ideally, they need to find a certified public accountant who provides financial planning. A professional of this type should have considerable experience and success with transforming UAWs. That is, they should have a strong track record in helping the Mr. Friends of the world become more PAW-like.

In extreme cases, a CPA/financial planner actually takes control of his client's purchasing behavior. He first audits the client's consumption habits over the past two years. He categorizes and tabulates each element. Then the accountant consults with the client. The client is put into a "cold turkey" cutback program, meaning that all elements of consumption are reduced by a minimum of 15 percent for the next year or two. Additional cutbacks follow. In some situations, the accountant/financial planner even keeps his client's checkbooks, writes all the checks, and pays all the bills. Cold turkey is not easy for most UAWs. But sometimes it's the only way to solve the problem.